Recalling the Batman tweet, he says, ‘It caught the imagination of a lot of young people and people said, wow, you know, the BJP is about Batman! My vote is for the BJP and that kind of stuff. Then we made one full series on the youth. We called it “My First Vote for Modi”. A lot of what we showed there was very young people … So, if you were speaking about women’s security, we showed a young couple who are probably seeing each other in college. The guy wanted to drop a girl home and she was saying, “Don’t worry, I can walk back home and I will be fine.” It was that kind of approach. So, we changed the language of communication and we use modern technology to do that. The idea was to make our content very relatable, if that’s the word.’

The Congress too tried various kinds of content, from comedy to satirical videos like its caustic ‘Bhakt ka chashma’ (devotee’s spectacles) clip, which shows a young man looking to buy goggles and being taken for a ride as he tries on a magic saffron pair that tints the way the world looks to him. Where there is poverty, the saffron goggles show a vision of prosperity; where there is sickness, they show neat and clean hospitals; and where there are pakoda sellers, they show happy, degree-wielding job holders. The problem for the Congress was that it just did not have enough reach on these videos.

Why did the Congress not saturate its social platforms beyond Twitter? Jairam Ramesh, who has directed several of the party’s election campaigns in the past, blames it on resources. ‘I have no reliable data,’ he says, ‘but I have been told they [the BJP] have 500 people working 24x7 on social media. We had twenty-five people working social media 24x7 in Delhi. If you add the number of people in other states doing social alone, then, nationwide, that number would not exceed sixty. BJP had at least ten times that number. In terms of manpower resources and in terms of financial resources, we were easily outflanked and it was visible in the disparity in presence.’[48]

Question the BJP’s IT Cell head on this claim, and Malviya’s response is: ‘Rubbish!’ ‘I have a twenty-two-member team here and eight people for technology and data analytics,’ he told me. ‘Why do I need fifty people or 500 people or whatever the number they give